MZUZU UNIVERSITY

FACULTY OF EDUCATION

Department of Languages and Literature

Centre for Open and Distance Learning

END OF SEMESTER EXAMINATIONS – April, 2017

COMM 1101: COMMUNICATION SKILLS I

DATE: Tuesday 18th April, 2017 **TIME:** 2hrs

(8:00-10:00 am)

Instruction: Answer **all** questions

Write the **name of your lecturer** on your answer booklet

Question 1

A. Briefly explain how a study plan would help you achieve your academic goals at this university. **(4 marks)**

B. Examination telepathy is a necessary skill that enables every student to maximise performance in examinations. How would such a skill help you to achieve this goal? **(4 marks)**

C. Read the text below and answer questions that follow:

One day I was informed by Mr Mell that Mr Creakle would be home that evening. In the evening, after tea, I heard that he was come. Before bedtime, I was fetched by the man with the wooden leg to appear before him. I went on my way, trembling, to Mr Creakle's presence: which so abashed me, when I was ushered into it, that I hardly saw Mrs Creakle or Miss Creakle (who were both there, in the parlour), or anything but Mr

introduction, 'Look here! Here's a game!' Happily, too, the greater part of the boys came back low-spirited, and were not so boisterous at my expense as I had expected. Some of them certainly did dance about me like wild Indians, and the greater part could not resist the temptation of pretending that I was a dog, and patting and smoothing me lest I should bite, and saying, 'Lie down, sir!' and calling me Towzer. This was naturally confusing, among so many strangers, and cost me some tears, but on the whole it was much better than I had anticipated.

I was not considered as being formally received into the school, however, until J. Steerforth arrived. Before this boy, who was reputed to be a great scholar, and was very good-looking, and at least half a dozen years my senior, I was carried as before a magistrate. He inquired, under a shed in the playground, into the particulars of my punishment, and was pleased to express his opinion that it was 'a jolly shame', for which I became bound to him ever afterwards.
'What money have you got, Copperfield?' he said, walking aside with me when he had disposed of my affair in these terms.
I told him seven shillings.
'You had better give it to me to take care of,' he said. At least, you can if you like. You needn't if you don't like.'
I hastened to comply with his friendly suggestion, and opening Peggotty's purse, turned it upside down into his hand.

'Do you want to spend anything now?' he asked me. 'No, thank you,' I replied.
'You can if you like, you know,' said Steerforth. 'Say the word.'
'No, thank you, sir,' I repeated. Perhaps you'd like to spend a couple of shillings or so in a bottle of currant wine by and by, up in the bedroom?' said Steerforth. 'You belong to my bedroom, I find.'

It certainly had not occurred to me before, but I said, 'Yes, I should like that.' 'Very good,' said Steerforth. 'You'll be glad to spend another shilling or so in almond cakes, I dare say?' I said, Yes I should like that, too.'

'And another shilling or so in biscuits, and another in fruit, eh?' said Steerforth. 'I say, young Copperfield, you're going it!' I smiled because he smiled, but I was a little troubled in my mind, too.

'Well!' said Steerforth. We must make it stretch as far as we can; that's all. I'll do the best in my power for you. I can go out when I like, and I'll smuggle the prog in.' With these words he put the money in his pocket, and kindly told me not to make myself uneasy; he would take care it should be all right.

He was as good as his word. When we went upstairs to bed he produced the whole seven shillings' worth, and laid it out on my bed in the moonlight, saying-
'There you are, young Copperfield, and a royal spread you've got!'

i. Mention the name of the boy who was badly bullied at this particular school and who was the bully? **(2 marks)**
ii. Copperfield was unwilling to let Steerforth keep the money for him. Explain why. **(2 marks)**
iii. As Copperfield had just come, how did Coperfield keep his money safely when he just came? How much was it? **(2 marks)**
iv. What does each of the following phrases mean as used in the passage:
   a). brought the water into my eyes. **(1 mark)**
   b). lest I should bite **(1 mark)**
   c). was a little troubled in my mind **(1 mark)**
   d). a jolly shame **(1 mark)**
   e). low spirited **(1 mark)**
v. Suggest a suitable title for this story. **(1mark)**

Question 2

A. What is communication? **(2 marks)**
B. Mention elements of the communication process and explain the role each one plays in the process. **(6marks)**

C. With the aid of diagrams explain the difference between the linear and the interactional models of communication **(7 marks)**

D. Briefly explain any **two** possible ways in which messages can get distorted in an on-going communication process. **(4 marks)**

E. Give any **two** advantages of oral communication over written communication. **(4 marks)**

Question 3

A. What **two** things would you do to enhance the quality of listening in a teaching and learning situation? **(4 marks)**

B. Discuss the assertion that 'the listener has the responsibility to listen even if the speaker is boring'. **(10 marks)**

C. Briefly explain the difference between critical listening and empathic listening **(3 marks)**

END OF QUESTION PAPER